this conflict clearly showed the LoC printed on it joining one prominent peak with the other. When this was shown to the Pakistanis, along with other documents such as identity cards and diaries during the meeting of the directors general of military operations at Attari near the Wagah border outpost on 11 July 1999, their faces turned red.

As far as our side was concerned, the Kargil Review Committee did a great service to the nation by bringing out their report in record time. They have comprehensively brought out the lessons that emerged during this war and I have no desire to go into those details. We in the MO directorate assisted this committee in preparing this report by making available all relevant records of Operation Vijay, the name we coined once the hostilities commenced in May 1999. All the same, I wish to share my personal observations of how we fought the war:

- We were indeed taken unawares and overwhelmed by the unexpected developments in Kargil. Though we had been getting some driblets of information in 1988–89 about Pakistani activities in the Kargil area, our focus remained on counterterrorism operations in J&K. It was a collective failure at all levels for us not to be able to make a cohesive analysis and see the big picture. I distinctly recollect reports of underslung loads being carried by helicopters in the valleys laterally along the LoC. There were some other reports of heightened activities across the LoC in Kargil sector. As the forward troops and the brigade, division and the corps HQ did not find anything unusual or amiss in that activity, we also let it pass. But what beats my comprehension is that the Pakistan Army was able to penetrate six to seven kilometers and occupy positions overlooking Dras and the highway, without being detected. There was not much snow on some of these very high and rugged features and therefore, our surveillance plans, which included ground patrols and aerial surveillance, left much to be desired. These intruders should have been discovered much earlier.